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Summary

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In this section, we will discuss the Summary chapter of your report. Often, this is the first chapter a reader will look at, to determine whether or not the report is relevant to him (or her).

Most important to remember is the fact that the Summary should be a stand-alone document: It should be comprehensible without looking at any other part of your report. To achieve this, it should contain the following components:

- A statement of the main problem,
- An outline of the main methods used to study it,
- The main conclusions drawn in the report.

This information is obviously repetitive for a reader going through your report from A to Z, but will be very useful to more casual readers.

Finally, keep your summary short. It should consist of a couple of paragraphs at most, and it should contain only those formulas that are absolutely essential (or none at all). A reader who is interested in the details can find them in the rest of your report.

Exercise A

1/1 point (graded)

Summary

During this research, we have analysed the given model and solved it in Matlab using Euler's method. Next, we have found values for the constants a and b . This showed that the model was not widely applicable: even for very small deviations in value, crashes could suddenly occur. This would mean that the model was only useful in very specific situations. To solve this problem, we have extended this model by an extra term, that takes into account the braking speed of the other vehicles. To test this extended model and to find a good value for the constant corresponding to the extra term, we have applied the model to a line of cars standing in front of

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behaviour of a car compared to its predecessor. By applying the extended model to the old situation, we have created a better model: it gives a more realistic view on traffic jams with different starting and ending speeds.

What is true about the (short) Summary chapter above?

Multiple answers may apply.

- ☐ It can be read as a stand-alone document.
- ☐ It gives a clear outline of the problem studied in this report.
- ☐ Its paragraph has a single purpose.
- ☒ It should be thoroughly rewritten. ✓



Answer

Correct:

Indeed, the summary should be thoroughly rewritten. It does not give a clear outline of the problem studied in the report. The first sentences refer to a model without giving any explanation as to what is being modelled here. Since the main problem is not outlined, this summary is not comprehensible as a stand-alone document either. Finally, this single paragraph should definitely be split up into several shorter ones.

Submit

You have used 3 of 10 attempts

i Answers are displayed within the problem

Next up, perhaps the most important part of a report: the Conclusions chapter. What should it contain, and how is it different from the Summary chapter?

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